

Chapter 2

There was a turning corner ahead—a small road that led to the theater.

The blazing sun was just blocked by the houses on both sides of the road.

Yin Lingzhu's bangs covered the ends of her eyebrows, revealing the relaxed and confident space between them. Her eyes curved into a beautiful arc from happiness, her pupils reflecting bright golden light. Her lips had been kissed by the sun into a deep red, yet the corners of her mouth curved upward.

She wore only a white shirt, black long pants, and canvas shoes. This outfit made her look like a student, and her slender figure was very eye-catching.

The blazing sunlight was not as dazzling as this Alpha at the moment.

Yin Lingzhu quickly ran to the entrance of the small road.

She saw Rong Yu's car still moving slowly and shouted at her, "Take your time driving. I'm not keeping you company anymore."

"You—" Before Rong Yu could finish speaking, Yin Lingzhu had disappeared.

"Drive faster!" She kicked the driver's seat hard, taking out all her anger on him.

Rong Yu leaned back in the car seat, secretly thinking about how to complete her plan.

"Drive faster." She kicked the seat again.

The car quickly arrived at the film crew. Rong Yu tidied her makeup, confirmed everything was fine, then got out of the car.

She took small steps running to her financial backer's side, intimately linking arms with him, and complained coquettishly: "Someone bullied me."

"Alright, alright, tell me what you want me to do." The financial backer was very pleased, touching Rong Yu's little face.

Rong Yu suppressed her discomfort and used her face to nuzzle his hand affectionately. "She's coming to audition with the crew later. There's an audition location with a swimming pool. Let's be there."

"Fine, I'll give the director a heads up."

Yin Lingzhu didn't have much money left and had to rely on walking.

In her original world, she was a programmer—one of the top tier ones.

Compared to her world, this world's computer development was at the same pace, so she had originally planned to earn some money this afternoon.

But with Rong Yu's interference, to avoid alerting the enemy¹, her afternoon time would probably be wasted.

When she arrived at the crew's audition room, Yin Lingzhu couldn't care about her image and collapsed into a chair.

"Hey you, come in and audition for the role."

Yin Lingzhu lifted her head when she heard the voice, looked to see who it was, and calculated how much more time she had to rest.

She discovered that this voice was calling her.

"Big brother, aren't you mistaken?" Yin Lingzhu pointed around her. "They all came before me."

"No mistake, it's you. Hurry up and go in."

Yin Lingzhu could only drag herself toward the audition room.

Inside the audition room, everywhere else was dim, with only the stage area having lighting.

But with the little light available, Yin Lingzhu could see where the judges' seats were.

"Xiao Yu told me you're here to audition for the second female lead. Go ahead and perform." A voice came from the judges' area.

Yin Lingzhu was confused—she hadn't even read the script. How was she supposed to perform?

"Director, could you let me look at the script?" Yin Lingzhu asked like a fool.

"You came to audition without even reading the script!" The director slammed the table, shouting angrily.

Earlier, the investor's little lover had come in saying her friend wanted to cut in line. For the sake of money, the director had reluctantly agreed.

Now this person who cut in line hadn't even read the script—what did she think this place was?

"Director, don't worry. My friend is especially talented. Please let her look at the script."

Rong Yu's soft and weak voice rang out, her sinister and malicious eyes staring closely at Yin Lingzhu, like a snake in the shadows.

Yin Lingzhu realized what was happening and was about to refuse when the director's voice interrupted her.

"Fine, if she performs poorly, she'll never get to audition for my productions again." The director, hearing Rong Yu's voice and thinking about the funding, forcibly suppressed his anger.

After receiving the script, Yin Lingzhu quickly flipped through it.

The scene Yin Lingzhu was to audition involved the second female lead retrieving a watch she had dropped in the swimming pool.

This meant Yin Lingzhu would need to go into the water.

Upon getting the script, Yin Lingzhu's face stiffened, then relaxed—she didn't need to actually go into the water.

"Director, doesn't our stage have a swimming pool?" Rong Yu's voice popped up again.

Before Yin Lingzhu could speak, the director refused first.

"That's not possible. What kind of audition would that be?"

"I also think this wouldn't showcase my acting skills properly." Yin Lingzhu immediately agreed.

Even though Yin Lingzhu couldn't act, she definitely didn't want to go into the water.

Yin Lingzhu's fear of water exceeded her fear of public humiliation.

Seeing her plan wasn't succeeding, Rong Yu shook her financial backer's arm.

"I think actors should experience it personally once to express the most authentic state." The financial backer touched Rong Yu's little hand, smiling as he spoke.

The director had to suppress his opinion once again.

Yin Lingzhu, powerless and alone, had no choice but to stand by the swimming pool.

At the same time, Rong Yu quietly opened her phone's camera, pointing it at her.

The lighting was very dim. The one-meter-deep pool seemed bottomless in Yin Lingzhu's eyes.

Fear surged up, accompanied by nausea. Yin Lingzhu's vision went black and she fainted.

When she woke up again, she was greeted by a pristine white ceiling, with the smell of disinfectant surrounding her nose.

"You're awake." A girl in a white coat put down her water cup and walked toward Yin Lingzhu.

"I'm your attending physician, You Xiaoxiao."

"Do you know? You've undergone a second differentiation." You Xiaoxiao sat down and said to Yin Lingzhu.

"Second differentiation?"

"Your girlfriend is here, she knows the details too." You Xiaoxiao gestured for her to turn her head.

A girl was sleeping on the adjacent hospital bed.

"I found her number in your phone." You Xiaoxiao explained.

"You had no one to take care of you, so I called her."

You Xiaoxiao's expression was a bit strange, whether because she had casually looked through Yin Lingzhu's phone or for some other reason.

The girl on the bed heard the commotion and woke up.

Seeing that Yin Lingzhu had opened her eyes, obvious joy appeared on her face.

"Doctor, could you step out for a moment?" Yin Lingzhu, seeing the girl had awakened, asked You Xiaoxiao somewhat embarrassedly.

After You Xiaoxiao left, the atmosphere in the room became a bit awkward.

Yin Lingzhu knew this girl—her name was Wan Miayin, and she was one of the fish in the original owner's pond².

Even one that couldn't be ranked.

"The doctor might have misunderstood our relationship." Wan Miayin tucked the hair hanging by her ear behind it, saying understandingly.

"Well, let's not contact each other anymore from now on." Yin Lingzhu lowered her head, not daring to look at her, her voice very small.

Warm yellow sunlight scattered on the floor and table, avoiding only the two of them.

"Why?" Wan Miayin clearly hadn't expected her to say such a thing. After being stunned for a while, she asked foolishly.

Yin Lingzhu remained silent. She didn't know how to face this kind of situation.

In her original world, she had never liked anyone, so she had never been in a relationship. Her experience in this area was very limited.

Time passed in Yin Lingzhu's silence, and the atmosphere became increasingly heavy.

"Okay." After an unknown amount of time, Yin Lingzhu heard this single word and lifted her head.

Wan Miayin was no longer in the room. Yin Lingzhu saw two water stains where she had been sitting, understanding in her heart that she had cried.

She sighed and took out her phone.

There were still many fish in the original owner's pond. She would resolve them all this afternoon.

Yin Lingzhu spent the entire afternoon breaking up with her ambiguous romantic interests.

You Xiaoxiao pushed open the door and, seeing that Yin Lingzhu was still there, secretly breathed a sigh of relief.

Yin Lingzhu was currently breaking up with the last fish.

You Xiaoxiao quickly walked to Yin Lingzhu's bedside, placing her hand on her forehead. "Good, no fever."

"After your second differentiation, your pheromone³ content has increased rapidly and needs to be released."

You Xiaoxiao lowered her hand and inadvertently saw Yin Lingzhu's phone screen.

"You really are popular." She teased.

"Doctor, what would happen if the pheromones aren't released?" Yin Lingzhu couldn't respond to her last comment, so she simply ignored it and asked about her confusion.

"Nothing much." You Xiaoxiao sat in the chair, tapping her chin. "You might just explode and die."

"Doctor, don't scare me." Yin Lingzhu's eyes widened, not daring to believe it.

You Xiaoxiao, seeing her expression, rattled off a bunch of information.

"Please, you differentiated into S-level. Do you know how rare that is?"

"Second differentiation into S-level Alpha—if it weren't for my good skills, you wouldn't be lying peacefully in bed."

"You underwent second differentiation, so your pheromones surged. Your glands⁴ can't handle it—you really could die."

After hearing all this, Yin Lingzhu deeply lamented her luck. She didn't need to pay the breach of contract penalty anymore; now she was about to kick the bucket directly.

"But you don't need to worry—after all, you have so many girlfriends." You Xiaoxiao said regretfully.

"I don't have girlfriends." Yin Lingzhu held up her phone. The previously full contact list now had only four or five people left.

"And I would only look for one girlfriend." Yin Lingzhu corrected.

You Xiaoxiao saw that she had deleted so many people and opened her mouth to speak, but was interrupted by her phone vibrating.

She glanced at Yin Lingzhu, saw that she wasn't paying attention to her, and hurriedly took her phone outside.

"What are you doing? I was just about to tell her."

"Don't you understand your own body?"

"Finally, someone suitable appears."

"You only have one month left."

After saying these things, You Xiaoxiao hung up and returned to the hospital room.

Footnotes:

¹ **Alerting the enemy:** This is a translation of the Chinese idiom "打草驚蛇" (literally "beating grass startles snake"), meaning to act carelessly and alert someone to your intentions before you're ready.

² **Fish in the pond:** In Chinese internet slang, maintaining multiple romantic interests is often described as "keeping fish in a pond" (養魚), where each romantic interest is a "fish." It refers to someone who maintains ambiguous relationships with multiple people without committing to any of them.

³ **Pheromones:** In the ABO universe, pheromones are chemical signals that Alphas, Betas, and Omegas emit. They play crucial roles in attraction, identification of secondary gender/level, and various biological processes. Higher-level individuals have more potent pheromones.

⁴ **Glands:** Refers to the scent glands located at the back of the neck in ABO fiction. These glands are responsible for producing and releasing pheromones, and are sensitive areas that play important roles in bonding and mating.